

to Google Trends, Indians topped the list for keywords like “pornography” and “sex.” Yes, the land of the Kama Sutra and being sex-starved and all... and we don’t need to repeat all that.

THE FOX SPREADS ITS WINGS

“What’s Internet Explorer?”

We cannot be sure if some—maybe just some—Microsoft workers use Firefox at home, but if you’re a loyal one, you wouldn’t. And your sense of pride of the world-domination would take a beating if you someone—in fact, any computer user in the world—were to ask you, “What’s Internet Explorer?”

Perhaps that’s why UK blogger and avid Firefox fan Danny Sullivan spread the news that his son had asked him that question. To deflate at least some MS egos.

Sullivan, we hear, succeeded in persuading his wife to drop the big

Malice

If you’ve ever been in these offices at the high-stress time of issue closing, you soon understand why it’s necessary to spew a little venom at the unsuspecting human beings that dare cross your path. It’s therapeutic, they say, and feels good (not to the spew-ee, obviously, but you can’t have everything).

The most deadly woe-causing force in these parts has to be Ajay—our resident BOFH (look it up, why don’t you). Somehow, our servers get lonely while he’s gone, and wantonly turn themselves off. Unbeknownst to our moody servers, poor Pillaiji loses a few strands of hair—“Aiyyo error!” (I/O Error. Get it? Heh, heh).

Adding to Pillaiji’s already mounting terror is The Browne Stain, who promptly decided to

fall ill the day he was supposed to clear his article before it went to print.

Going further down the halls, we find SKOAR!’s ed Badri (None shall be spared! Yarrrrr!) dancing away to—cue dropped jaws here—the latest Bollywood tunes! Not in reality, though—we wouldn’t have survived the shock—but he’s found joy in a new multiplayer dance game. The shocking truth...

In other news, we’ve got us a new ~~minion~~ writer—young Bhaskar Sarma. He’s bald—shinier than our reigning billiard ball, Raaabo, even. By choice. Really. He could grow his hair back if he felt like it. Don’t let Raaabo find out.

We shan’t bitch about the ed here; you don’t spew at people who pay you.

Well, not in public.

DIGIT DIARY

blue E. Apparently, it had sometimes crashed on her. So the missus moved over to Firefox full-time. And since hers is the hand that had rocked the cradle, the kids took the Firefox path as well (after they were out of the cradle, at any rate), and soon the whole family was hooked.

The aforementioned question came up when Sullivan’s eight-year-old son wanted to browse the

Net and his preferred browser wouldn’t work. (OK, Opera fans, time to gloat.) But Sullivan is no Opera fan, and he didn’t have it installed, it seems—so he suggested the kid to use IE instead.

Surprise probably ensued when his son replied asking, “Internet Explorer? What’s that?” Sullivan has said on the Web that his son has access to the Internet from school,

but he doesn’t know what browser they use there. Clearly, it’s not IE.

And that’s that. We just wanted to tell you a story pointing to the rising popularity of Firefox instead of one of those news items that go, “Firefox use in Bamako up by 2.3% in June 2007 from the corresponding figure for January! Now go to Mozilla.org.(Mali’s Internet code) and buy a T-shirt!” ☒

Blog WATCH

Has the iPhone and related news been flogged to death? Bloggers don’t seem to think so. And Intel getting onto the OLPC thing... who would think?

Frank Hayes

www.computerworld.com/blogs/node/5864

Firefox fixed—now it’s Microsoft’s turn

Seven days after a zero-day vulnerability surfaced that involves both Internet Explorer and Firefox, the developers at Mozilla have released a patch. Microsoft, for its part, says the security hole in IE is a feature, not a bug.

For a week after the problem surfaced, security pundits were taking sides to pin the blame on either Firefox or IE... So now, a week later, Firefox has issued its patch. The IE/Firefox security hole is closed—on the Firefox end...

Lisa Vaas

<http://apple-iphone-news-articles.blogspot.com/2007/07/hackers-close-to-cracking-iphone.html> (<http://tinyurl.com/2rhpxj>)

Hackers close to Cracking iPhone

iPhone hackers are on the cusp of not only being able to write programs for the phone but also finding a way to cut the device’s tether to Cingular’s service plans...

One of the first iPhone hacks came from Jon Lech Johansen, aka DVD Jon. A self-trained Norwegian software engineer, Johansen on July 3 announced on his blog that he had hacked a new, unactivated

iPhone, managing to activate it without turning on AT&T Cingular phone service. But although Johansen managed to get the iPod and Wi-Fi capabilities of an iPhone turned on with his hack, he couldn’t get the device to work as a phone...

There are reasons why unlocking an iPhone is a bad idea, however...

Frank Hayes

www.computerworld.com/blogs/node/5847

Intel folds on OLPC

Everyone is being polite about Intel’s decision to join the OLPC consortium... Intel has been pouring insults at the OLPC ever since MIT’s Nicholas Negroponte started the project. On the surface, that made no sense: Nobody was going to use one of these little ruggedized PCs in competition with the high-end laptops that Intel made CPUs for, so the most reasonable position for an unsupportive Intel would be to sit smugly by.

But Intel didn’t do that. Intel honcho Craig Barrett went out of his way to trash-talk the OLPC machine. Even when it turned out Intel was working on its own cheap student PC, the Classmate... Intel’s Classmate finally hit the streets in March. Apparently it didn’t take the Third World by storm. And now, four months later, Intel has decided that maybe this OLPC crowd has a good idea after all.